

# [GAME NAME] — THREE PRE-BUILT PATHS

Paths are **guidance, not rules**. Each is a complete plan from creation to Level 10; swap any pick for any Talent whose gates you meet. Level 1 is the pre-Talent baseline — your dice, tier, and traits carry you until Level 2. All numbers marked (tunable) in the rules are playtest targets.

## THE RECKONING — a Berserker's path

*Frontline fury. You want enemies swinging at you, because every attack that comes your way is fuel, and every drop of your own blood is a promise.*

|             |                                                                                                                                    |               |                                                            |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Health Tier | Frontline (9 + Vigor max HP)                                                                                                       | Starting Dice | Vigor d6 · Resolve d6 · Agility d4 · Focus d4              |
| Traits      | Heavy-Handed, Steel-Nerved                                                                                                         | Die Increases | L3 Vigor→d8 · L5 Vigor→d10 · L7 Resolve→d8 · L9 Agility→d6 |
| Gear        | Heavy cleaver (Vicious) or war-axe & shield · medium armor (or war-paint for Unarmored Bulwark later) · javelins · explorer's pack |               |                                                            |

|                        |                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Creation spend (20 CP) | Vigor d6 (3) · Resolve d6 (3) · Frontline (6) · Martial weapons (2) · Medium armor (2) · Shields (1) · Specialty: Intimidation (2) · +50g (1) = 20 CP |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| Lv | Talent                    | Why                                                             |
|----|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | <b>Primal Fury</b>        | Momentum when enemies target you; emergency temp HP.            |
| 4  | <b>Crimson Tide</b>       | Below half HP, every melee attack rolls a bonus Vigor Die.      |
| 6  | <b>Retributive Strike</b> | 2 Momentum: answer a melee hit with an Upgraded attack.         |
| 8  | <b>Crimson Rampage</b>    | Kills chain into free movement and another attack.              |
| 10 | <b>Relentless</b>         | Once per combat, refuse to drop; full Momentum, auto-Explosion. |

- Wade in and spend AP on attacks — your Momentum arrives when enemies answer.
- Furious Strike (swap a pick, or grab it in another campaign) and flat spends turn glancing rounds into kills; hold 2 tokens for Retributive Strike.
- Below half HP you get stronger, not weaker. Trust the tide.

## THE EQUATION — an Arcanist's path

*Magic as engineering. You spend Focus like a budget, weave modifications into every casting, and treat each Explosion as compounding interest.*

|             |                                                                         |               |                                                          |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Health Tier | Adept (5 + Vigor max HP)                                                | Starting Dice | Focus d6 · Agility d6 · Vigor d4 · Resolve d4            |
| Traits      | Quick-Witted, Perceptive                                                | Die Increases | L3 Focus→d8 · L5 Focus→d10 · L7 Agility→d8 · L9 Vigor→d6 |
| Gear        | Arcane Vestments · a Conduit staff or wand · formulary & scholar's pack |               |                                                          |

|                        |                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Creation spend (20 CP) | Focus d8 (8) · Agility d6 (3) · Adept (0) · School of Evocation (4) · Arcane Armaments (2) · Arcane Vestments (2) · +50g (1) = 20 CP |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| Lv | Talent                     | Why                                                         |
|----|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | <b>School of Evocation</b> | Tier 0 element bolts now; Tiers 2/3 unlock at 5 and 9.      |
| 4  | <b>Spell Weaving</b>       | 1 Momentum riders: double range, or Sunder Agility Defense. |
| 6  | <b>Aetheric Siphon</b>     | Every spell Explosion pays you 1 Momentum.                  |
| 8  | <b>Advanced Weaving</b>    | Vicious and knockback Weaves join the toolkit.              |
| 10 | <b>Master of the Weave</b> | Two Weaves per spell, one of them free each turn.           |

- Open with cheap Tier 1 spells to bait Explosions; Siphon converts them to Momentum.
- Weave-Sunder a target, then pour your big Tier 2 into the softened defense.
- Keep 2 Focus in reserve for the round that matters — overspending early is how Adepts die.

## THE LONG WATCH — a Stalker's path

*Patience made lethal. Mark the kill, control the angles, and let the quarry spend its whole life walking into the one moment you prepared.*

|             |                                                                                                                                 |               |                                                            |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Health Tier | Skirmisher (7 + Vigor max HP)                                                                                                   | Starting Dice | Agility d6 · Focus d6 · Vigor d4 · Resolve d4              |
| Traits      | Agile, Streetwise                                                                                                               | Die Increases | L3 Agility→d8 · L5 Agility→d10 · L7 Focus→d8 · L9 Vigor→d6 |
| Gear        | Hunter's bow & arrows or paired hunting blades (Finesse) · cured hides · stalker's kit (caltrops, tripwire, smoke) · field pack |               |                                                            |

|                        |                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Creation spend (20 CP) | Agility d6 (3) · Focus d6 (3) · Skirmisher (3) · Martial weapons (2) · Light armor (1) · Specialties: Tracking, Survival (4) · Battle Sense (4) = 20 CP |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| Lv | Talent                     | Why                                                       |
|----|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | <b>Marked Quarry</b>       | Always know where it is; Upgraded attacks against it.     |
| 4  | <b>Hunter's Instinct</b>   | Momentum from exploiting cover, surprise, and conditions. |
| 6  | <b>Visceral Quarry</b>     | Once a round, a hit on your Quarry is all True Damage.    |
| 8  | <b>Apex Predator</b>       | Your Quarry cannot run, hide, or vanish from you.         |
| 10 | <b>One With the Wastes</b> | Move at full speed Hidden; kills refill Momentum.         |

- Mark before you shoot. Two stacked Upgrades on round one is your baseline.
- Fight from Cover — it feeds Hunter's Instinct and starves the enemy's math.
- Save the Visceral declaration for the turn their Defense would blunt you most.